9. It is better to serve the fruit raw without much cooking or taking juice out of it. Everyday diet should contain at least one medium size fruit

10. There should be a minimum of milk 100ml/ day, one to 2 glasses of milk or curd should be included in balanced diet

11. Energy derived from oils or fats is 15-20% of total calories and 5% from sugar and jaggery

12. One egg weighs around 40g of protein. This can be served along with cereal or pulses to improve the quality of protein. Instead of one serving of poultry/fish, one egg can also be included in the diet

13. Inclusion of salads not only help in meeting the vitamin requirements but the meals would be attractive and have high satiety value, due to the fiber content

14. Fried foods cannot be planned if oil allowance is less or in low caloric diets

15. One third of nutritional requirement atleast calories, protein should be met by lunch and dinner

16. If possible meals should be planned for seven days

17. Usually the number of meals would be four and for every young children and sick persons, the number of meals can be more

18. Ideally each meal should consist of all the 5 food groups

19. For quick calculations average value of calories and proteins from the same group can be taken

Principles of planning a meal:

- **Meeting nutritional requirement**: A good menu is one which will not only provide adequate calories, fat and protein but also minerals, vitamins essential for the physical wellbeing of each member of a family
- **Meal pattern must fulfill family needs**: A family meal should cater to the needs of the different members
- **Meal planning should save time and energy:** Planning of meals should be done in such a way, that the recipes should be simple nutrition. By using pressure cooker, time and energy can be saved
- **Economic consideration:** Any meals that do not satisfy the budget of the family, cannot be put into practice. The cost may be reduced by using the 1. Seasonal foods 2. Bulk purchasing 3. Substituting greens for fruits 4. Combinations of foods
- **Meal plan should give maximum nutrients:** Loss of nutrients delivering, procuring, cooking should be minimized. Sprouted grains, malted cereals, fermented foods enhanced nutritive value



- **Consideration for individual likes and dislikes**: Meal should be planned according to the individual preferences likes vegetarian

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